French-German deal on cars close

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【要点】

・フランスとドイツが「ヨーロッパ製」の定義緩和と自動車排出基準の柔軟化を交換条件とする取引をまとめようとしており、木曜夜の時点ではまだ合意に至っていない。

・欧州委員会が提案した2035年の排出削減目標90%を無条件化し、代替燃料への投資で追加10%削減することで実質80%の削減目標を設定する案が検討されている。

・自動車産業は排出クレジットの積み立て制度を獲得し、プラグインハイブリッド車の燃費計算基準も2030年1月1日まで凍結される見通しである。

・グリーンスチールへの投資が協定から除外されることで、鉄鋼業界の主要市場が失われる可能性がある。

【メール原文】

Presented by BMW Group By JORDYN DAHL with TOMMASO LECCA and MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — Paris and Berlin are moving closer to a quid pro quo deal on t

Presented by BMW Group

By JORDYN DAHL

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SNEAK PEEK

— Paris and Berlin are moving closer to a quid pro quo deal on the Industrial Accelerator Act and CO2 emissions for automakers.

— EU leaders are set to discuss the Black Sea situation today — after the Romanian and Bulgarian leaders met NATO chief Mark Rutte over more drone strikes on merchant shipping.

— The U.N.’s aviation agency backed airlines against the extension of ETS to flights to the Middle East.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Tips to jdahl@politico.eu , tlecca@politico.eu and msapio@politico.eu . Follow us @tommylecca , @jordyndahl and @martsapio .

Mark your calendars: Our weekly mobility calendar landed in your inbox on Thursday. You can also go online to export and plan your week or suggest your own event.

DRIVING THE DAY

NO WHITE SMOKE ON FRANCO-GERMAN DEAL: Paris and Berlin are close to finalizing a quid pro quo deal that will see Germany give ground on which countries qualify as “Made in Europe” in the Industrial Accelerator Act in exchange for more flexibility for automakers on the emission standards. However, as of Thursday night they had not yet reached an agreement. We have the latest draft here .

By the numbers: The European Commission proposed lowering the 2035 target from 100% emissions reduction to 90%, but on the condition that the extra emissions be offset through investments in green steel and alternative fuels. The draft French-German deal would make that 90% target unconditional and add an extra 10% reduction through alternative fuels, setting an effective emission reduction target of 80%.

Bye, bye, bye: Under the agreement, investments in green steel would no longer be required to qualify for the extra emissions. “This destroys the lead market for the steel industry,” a steel industry lobbyist told our colleague Tom Schmidtgen.

Banking mechanism: The draft agreement includes a longtime ask from automakers: The ability to bank emission credits in years they exceed the targets for use in years when they miss them. But the deal wouldn’t give a blanket banking mechanism, instead allowing only CO2 credits generated in 2029 (the next interim target for automakers is set for 2030) and not exceeding 7 grams CO2/km per automaker.

Utility factor: The automotive sector also got its wish of freezing the utility factor, at least until Jan. 1, 2030. The factor calculates the emissions from a plug-in hybrid based on how often the vehicle’s electric motor is used rather than the combustion engine. The current calculation, favored by industry, is based on lab data, while the Commission updated it with real-world data that shows consumers use the combustion engine more frequently.

An exception: The factor would only be frozen for plug-in hybrids that have a minimum electric range of 80 kilometers. “From 2030 onwards, the Utility Factor should be updated annually on the basis of observed real-world data from the preceding year,” the draft says.

More supercredits: The Commission proposal would give automakers that produce small EVs a 1.3 supercredit — which makes a qualifying car count as more than one vehicle — with the initiative going into effect in 2034. The French-German deal would make a 1.2 supercredit available to an electric vehicle of any size, so long as it meets “Made in Europe” requirements. Small “Made in Europe” EVs, meanwhile, would get a 1.4 supercredit. Manufacturers would be eligible for the credits once the legislation is signed, likely in 2027.

Who’s in: The concessions for the auto industry come at a price for Germany, which has advocated for a broader list of countries included under “Made with Europe” so as not to anger trade partners. Under the draft, Berlin accepted stricter criteria for industry, with only the 27 EU member countries included, and the United Kingdom under certain conditions.

State of play: Both sides said late Thursday evening that negotiations would continue today. Read more here .

AVIATION

ICAO SIDES WITH AIRLINES AGAINST ETS EXTENSION: The Commission's proposal to extend the Emissions Trading System to flights to the Middle East and North Africa is a threat to the U.N.'s Carbon Offsetting and Reduction Scheme for International Aviation, ICAO Council President Toshiyuki Onuma said Thursday.

Speaking in Brussels at a conference held by airline lobby IATA, Onuma reaffirmed the aviation agency's preference for keeping CORSIA as the sole global market-based measure addressing international aviation emissions, a position shared by the airline industry.

"Corrective and harmonized action through ICAO is the most effective way to address climate change," Onuma said. But "one of the most significant risks is the fragmentation of policy and market," he added. "The effectiveness and credibility of global solutions is undermined by uncoordinated national and local rules like the proposed expansion of the EU ETS," Onuma said. Regional schemes like the ETS "would also cause damage to the multilateral global approach."

Let's keep discussing: DG MOVE Director Magda Kopczyńska did not react to ICAO's criticism. "We have been supporting ICAO in working together, in discussing what should and might be priorities for the aviation policy," she said. Kopczyńska added that the upcoming EU aviation strategy will focus on strengthening the sector "as a part of a strong multilateral and international system."

Be my guest: The airline lobby quickly cashed in on Onuma's support. "If the world agrees on a system that works and it's committed to get to net-zero by 2050, who are the Europeans to disagree with that?" said Thomas Reynaert, IATA's senior vice president for external affairs. "You should be using a system that the world, rather than a separate region, accepts," Reynaert told Tommaso.

Mandatory, but not everywhere: CORSIA enters its mandatory phase in 2027, but its effectiveness will depend on countries implementing the offsetting obligations.

Echoing the industry: The latest message from ICAO "is yet another example of the organization echoing industry advocacy rather than acting as an impartial international body," said Béatrice des Boscs, senior aviation analyst at InfluenceMap, a think tank that monitors corporate and industry association lobbying on climate policy.

Theory vs. practice: The Commission assessment of the U.N. offsetting mechanism "concluded that CORSIA fails to adequately cover international aviation emissions," des Boscs told Tommaso. "Although eight out of the 10 largest aviation emitters theoretically participate, only two have implemented a legal obligation to offset emissions."

Too little, too late: She also criticized the Commission's proposal, saying it "falls short of its original ambition to cover all flights departing and arriving in the European Economic Area."

A message from BMW Group: Under current rules, two electric vehicles may both be zero-emissions, yet have very different carbon footprints. If Europe wants to reduce carbon dioxide as effectively as possible, every ton saved should count. BMW Group's Dr. Frank Niederländer explains why we need to look beyond the tailpipe. Read the interview with POLITICO Studio here .

MARITIME

BLACK SEA SECURITY PULLS LEADERS OUT OF EUCO: EU leaders are set to discuss the Black Sea situation today, after Romanian President Nicu□or Dan and Bulgarian Prime Minister Rumen Radev stepped away from Thursday's European Council to meet NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte over the

latest drone strikes on merchant shipping .

Another ship hit: Romanian authorities are carrying out a major search-and-rescue operation after a San Marino-flagged vessel was hit near Sulina, according to Romanian media . Five crew members were evacuated to hospital and seven remained missing as of Thursday afternoon. The incident follows another suspected strike in the area the previous evening and comes after a string of attacks on merchant ships near Bulgaria and Romania over the past two weeks.

NATO next: Dan said Rutte expressed the alliance's solidarity and said that the North Atlantic Council will discuss the wider Black Sea situation. Romania is now asking for the same kind of allied help it sought after drone incidents along its Danube border with Ukraine last year, when countries including the U.S., France, Spain, Italy, Slovakia and Portugal provided equipment. But Dan stressed Bucharest has not asked to trigger NATO's Article 4 or Article 5, and said it is still too early to attribute the latest incidents.

Bulgaria's ask: Radev said after meeting Rutte that "Black Sea security is Eastern Flank security," and that NATO stands ready to help Bulgaria and Romania strengthen anti-drone capabilities and maritime monitoring. Sofia is also pushing for collective action to restore safe navigation in the Black Sea.

HORMUZ RISK SPIKES: Two commercial ships were sunk near the Strait of Hormuz, sharpening the maritime-security debate just as EU leaders discuss the Middle East, freedom of navigation and the impact on global supply chains at today's European Council.

What happened: The GFS Pride, operated by Global Feeder Shipping, sank after being hit near the strait; Iran has blamed a mine, while other accounts point to a projectile. The bulk carrier Cape Dao also sank after an earlier attack.

Shipping under pressure: The sinkings come amid a sharp rise in attacks on commercial vessels around Hormuz, where operators are already relying on escorts, altered sailing patterns and other workarounds to keep cargo moving. The result is the same problem the market has faced for months: physical flows can continue, but only with much higher security, insurance and freight costs.

Red Sea link: Yemen's foreign minister, Afrah Abdelaziz Azouba, told reporters on Wednesday that pressure on the Hormuz and Bab al-Mandab straits is increasingly interconnected, arguing that disruption at both chokepoints gives Iran and the Houthi rebels leverage over international trade. She called on the EU to strengthen its measures against Houthi financing and supply networks and to coordinate more closely with Washington, while also backing more support for Yemen's coast guard.

Brussels watch: The Middle East is on today's EUCO agenda. The EU, through its top diplomat Kaja Kallas, has already called for stronger maritime-security capabilities, including through the naval mission Aspides in the Red Sea, but the latest sinkings add pressure for measures that materially reduce the risk to commercial shipping.

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PIT STOPS

From us : What was supposed to be a debate on energy prices devolved into a three-hour battle on taxing car emissions.

A message from BMW Group: Europe’s automotive industry is entering a crucial decade. As manufacturers navigate electrification, global competition, geopolitical uncertainty and rising energy costs, Europe faces the challenge of delivering decarbonization while strengthening competitiveness and resilience. In this Q&A , POLITICO Studio speaks to Dr. Frank Niederländer, Vice President for Government Affairs Europe at BMW Group, about the choices and conditions that will shape the next phase of Europe’s automotive transition. He discusses how Europe can strengthen the industrial base behind the transition, what it will take to build a competitive battery ecosystem and why establishing new capabilities requires the right investment conditions — and time to scale. He also explores why we should look beyond tailpipe emissions to consider the full value chain, and the potential role of renewable fuels alongside electrification. And why the transition will only succeed if it works for consumers and businesses while keeping investment, innovation and value creation in Europe.

Headlines

Here’s a recap of yesterday’s news, along with Pro articles and alerts from overnight.

Late discord delays Franco-German deal on Made in Europe, car emissions
The draft pact supports tighter eligibility rules for non-EU countries to participate in public procurement and public support, and softens the 2035 combustion engine ban.
By Giorgio Leali, Jordyn Dahl, Tom Schmidtgen, Hans von der Burchard · Oct 15, 2026, 11:22 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

EU leaders’ summit descends into 3-hour argument over taxing car emissions
Right-wing leaders used discussions to attack one of Europe’s most important climate policies.
By Ben Makuch · Oct 15, 2026, 07:13 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Von der Leyen eyes curbs on Chinese chemicals, machinery next
Brussels is looking at ways to protect the two industries, after a deal with China to limit imports of hybrid vehicles.
By Camille Gijs, Carlo Martuscelli, Hans von der Burchard, Jordyn Dahl · Oct 15, 2026, 03:56 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

NATO allies to meet over Black Sea drone attacks on shipping
The North Atlantic Council will hold talks to discuss the crisis after a succession of cargo ships were struck by drones in the region, Romanian President Nicu□or Dan tells POLITICO.
By Tim Ross · Oct 15, 2026, 03:41 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Six more countries demand halt to EU’s new emissions trading scheme
By Ben Makuch, Ben Munster · Oct 15, 2026, 01:50 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

UK is prepared to align with EU tariffs on Chinese EVs, minister indicates
U.K. Trade Minister Anas Sarwar says London should work with Brussels to counter China’s carmaking dominance.
By Caroline Hug, Stefanie Bolzen, Graham Lanktree · Oct 15, 2026, 01:23 pm Europe/Brussels CEST

Weekly Calendar

Here’s a selection of upcoming key events, find the complete Week Ahead online.

Eurocontrol ‘NDOP/NDTECH/NETOPS Workshop’ Event
Oct 19, 2026, 2:00 PM · Brussels, BE

Council Working Party on Aviation
Oct 20, 2026 · Brussels, BE

IATA ‘Timatic User Forum’
Oct 21, 2026 - Oct 22, 2026 · Geneva, CH

Coreper I
Oct 21, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Coreper II
Oct 21, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Council Working Party on Land Transport
Oct 21, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Council Working Party on Transport (Intermodal Questions and Networks)
Oct 22, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Coreper I
Oct 23, 2026 · Brussels, BE

Pro Intelligence Connections
2021/0211(COD) Revision of the EU Emissions Tradin…
Discussions within the Council or its preparatory…

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